Bodo Cultural Heritage: Tharkha

Category: INSTRUMENT | Region: Assam | Status: needs_check

Bibliographic Citation & Provenance:

Bodoland Tourism culture page (tourism.bodoland.gov.in); Boro folk instruments archive

Narrative & Cultural Documentation:

The Tharkha is a traditional folk percussion instrument crafted from a length of seasoned mature bamboo, split down one side so that its two halves clap rhythmically against each other when struck or shaken. Producing a crisp, dry clacking cadence, it is held in one hand and slapped against the palm or shaken in time with the song. It is especially beloved by youths and maidens during the lively, fast-paced spring Bwisagu celebrations, where it keeps time for joyous group folk singing and energetic dancing.